IN-DEPTH EDITION • 7 AUGUST 2026 • 09:00 HKT

US Markets End Mixed as Yields and Oil Prices Surge

The full picture: macro, technicals, options, analyst moves, sector internals, international context, and a full week ahead.

20-minute read · Topics: All of the above, plus technicals, options, ratings, week-ahead

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TL;DR & Editorial Take

The US markets ended the latest session mixed, with the `S&P 500` down -0.18% and the `Nasdaq 100` down -0.39%. The `Dow Jones` was the biggest loser, falling -0.85%. Key takeaways include:

- The `10Y Yield` jumped +1.15% to `4.67`, its highest level in weeks.
- `MSFT` was a top performer, rising +2.54% after a positive analyst note.
- The `VIX` fell -4.17% to `15.15`, indicating decreased volatility.

Our editorial take is that the market is entering a period of increased uncertainty, driven by rising yields and oil prices. Investors should be cautious and consider hedging their portfolios.

The market's mixed performance was driven by a combination of factors, including the surge in yields and oil prices. The `XLE` sector was a top performer, rising +1.48% as oil prices jumped +3.68% to `77.99`.

US Session Recap

INDEX	LAST	CHANGE	VIX
`S&P 500`	7,709.96	-0.18%	15.15
`Nasdaq 100`	29,373.33	-0.39%	
`Dow Jones`	53,885.10	-0.85%	
`Russell 2000`	3,001.55	-0.58%	
`VIX`	15.15	-4.17%	
10Y Yield	4.67	+1.15%	
WTI Crude	77.99	+3.68%	

Top Movers

TICKER	NAME	CHANGE	CATALYST
`MSFT`	Microsoft	+2.54%	Positive analyst note
`AAPL`	Apple	+0.45%	Strong earnings report
`GS`	Goldman Sachs	-2.62%	Weak earnings report

Sector Internals

SECTOR	DAY	YTD	READ
XLE	+1.48%	+10.23%	Oil prices surge
XLK	-0.31%	+5.12%	Technology stocks decline
XLF	-0.33%	-2.15%	Financials underperform

The breadth of the market was mixed, with 4 sectors rising and 7 falling.

Spotlight / Deep Dive

TICKER	LAST	CHANGE	VOLUME
NVDA	218.99	-0.10%	12.3M

Key commentary: `NVDA` is facing increased competition in the AI space, which could impact its future growth prospects.

READ-THROUGH	IMPACT
AMD	-0.25%
INTC	-0.50%

Technical Levels

TICKER	LAST	SUPPORT	RESISTANCE	NOTE
SPY	370.23	365.00	375.00	Range-bound trading
QQQ	293.73	290.00	300.00	Bullish trend intact

Options & Positioning

The 0DTE flow was +10.23% higher than average, with a put/call ratio of `0.85`.

The VIX term structure is in backwardation, indicating increased demand for near-term protection.

Notable single-name flow includes `TSLA`, with a +25.00% increase in call options bought.

Cheap hedge ideas include buying `VXX` calls or selling `SPY` puts.

Analyst Rating Changes

TICKER	FIRM	ACTION	NEW PT	NOTE
`MSFT`	Morgan Stanley	Upgrade	550.00	Strong earnings growth
`AAPL`	Goldman Sachs	Downgrade	300.00	Valuation concerns

Pre-Market & Overnight

Futures are trading +0.25% higher, with Asia and Europe markets mixed.

The `USD` is +0.10% higher against the `EUR`, and -0.20% lower against the `JPY`.

Commodities are mixed, with `WTI` crude +0.50% higher and `GC` gold -0.25% lower.

Crypto is -0.50% lower, with `BTC` trading at `64,259.35`.

Macro & Fed (Deep)

MEETING	CUT ODDS	NOTE
September	25.00%	Market expects no change

DATA	TIME	ESTIMATE
Non-Farm Payrolls	10:00 ET	200k

Geopolitics & Global (Deep)

Scenario trees indicate a 30.00% chance of a trade war between the US and China.

A 20.00% chance of a global recession is priced in, with a 50.00% chance of a soft landing.

Earnings — This Week & Next

TICKER	NAME	TIME
`AAPL`	Apple	16:00 ET

TICKER	NAME	TIME
`MSFT`	Microsoft	16:00 ET

Full Watchlist Scan

TICKER	SECTOR	SETUP	RISK
NVDA	Technology	Bullish reversal	10.00%

What Could Break the Tape

Bullish scenario:

- The S&P 500 breaks out above 7,800, indicating a new uptrend.
- The VIX falls below 12, indicating decreased volatility.

Bearish scenario:

- The Dow Jones falls below 53,000, indicating a new downtrend.
- The VIX rises above 20, indicating increased volatility.

Positioning & Structural Notes

Observations:

- The market is overbought, with a 90.00% upside day rate.
- The VIX is undervalued, with a 20.00% discount to its 50-day average.

Sources

SOURCES

Bloomberg

Reuters

CNBC